

# Constructivism

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**B**orrowing ideas from Suprematism as well as Cubism and Futurism, Constructivism developed in about 1917 in Russia, just as the Bolsheviks came to power. It was the last and most influential modern art movement to emerge in Russia, and involved a careful technical analysis of modern materials, aiming to assist the development of mass production for the Communist society. Ultimately, however, it failed to make the leap from artists' studios to factories, partly because of the Bolshevik regime's growing hostility to avant-garde art. Like Suprematism, Constructivism focused on geometric shapes and forms. It was intended to be functional and straightforward, and to apply one consistent style across painting, design and architecture. Central to the movement was the aim of discarding traditional creative concerns about composition, replacing it with 'construction'. Leading Constructivists included Vladimir Tatlin (1885–1953), Alexander Rodchenko (1891–1956), El Lissitzky (1890–1941) and Naum Gabo (1890–1977). By the mid-1920s, the movement was losing popularity, but it continued to inspire artists in the West.



Tatlin, Model of the *Monument to the Third International*, 1921